Sven van Holten Charria

Email · LinkedIn · Website

Education

London School of Economics and Political Science 2024 – 2025
MSc Econometrics and Mathematical Economics (distinction)
Selected modules: Econometric theory, Further topics in econometrics, Advanced macroeconomics.

Erasmus University Rotterdam 2019 – 2024
Double BSc in Econometrics & Economics (honours)
Selected modules: Advanced econometrics, Macroeconometrics, Macroeconomic theory, Time-series econometrics, Analysis, Probability theory, Statistical theory, Stochastic processes.

Chinese University of Hong Kong 2023
Exchange semester (distinction)
Selected modules: Machine learning for economics, Chinese exchange rate reforms.

Research Positions

Pre-doctoral Research Assistant 2025 – present
Centre for Macroeconomics, LSE

Research assistant to Ricardo Reis:

- Extended an analytical model of China's parallel-currency system; proved equilibrium existence and derived sufficient conditions for uniqueness (Bahaj and Reis, 2026a).
- Contributed to calibration quantifying seigniorage and liquidity revenues (Bahaj and Reis, 2026b).
- Constructed price-adjustment moments from microdata to analyse inflation dynamics (Reis, 2026a).
- Compiled and analysed cross-country debt data and government liability composition (Reis, 2026b).
- Developed a novel AI-chip investment model with obsolescence, demand growth and supply constraints.

Research assistant to Jonathon Hazell:

- Reconstructed a historical series of veterans' transfers from undigitised Treasury bulletins to provide data central to the paper's identification strategy (Guerreiro et al., 2026).
- Prepared UK price microdata for machine-learning inflation forecasting (Chen et al., 2026).
- Co-authoring a paper with Hazell and Maarten de Ridder using agentic AI to improve Compustat R&D investment measurement and estimates of R&D's causal effect on economic growth.

Working Papers

Reading the Missing Intercept — *Research proposal*, 2026.

- Uses household decision rules and market clearing to study identification of aggregate equilibrium effects from cross-sectional responses, with a proposed application to regional stock-wealth shocks.

Optimism and Overcommitment in Investment Booms — *Research proposal*, 2026.

- Studies how optimistic beliefs drive overinvestment and repayment exposure, using a model of diagnostic expectations and preliminary evidence from US shale to inform the AI buildout.

Completed Papers

The Legibility of Income Risk — *Paper*, 2026.

- Examines why similar income fluctuations can produce different perceptions of risk, using pay-composition evidence and a Bayesian learning model with predictable temporary payments.

Intuitive Inference: Enhancing Post-Double Selection Inference on Treatment Effects with Intuition-Based Penalties — *BSc Thesis*, 2024.

- Develops belief-informed penalties for post-double selection and establishes conditions for asymptotically valid inference, with simulations and an application to abortion and crime.

MRF-ARCH: A Machine Learning Approach to Forecast USD/GBP Tail Risk in a High Dimensional Dataset — *Seminar Paper*, 2024, with Maurizio Raina.

- Introduces a tractable random-forest extension of ARCH with time-varying volatility parameters, tracing how Brexit and COVID-19 affect USD/GBP baseline volatility and shock persistence.

Extracurriculars

TokoTalks Committee, *A.S.C./A.V.S.V.* 2021 – 2023

- Founding treasurer of the largest Dutch student association's interview platform. Managed budgets and sponsorships, recruited and prepared interviews for political and business leaders, including a Dutch deputy prime minister, Volt Europa's co-president, and CEOs of Flow Traders, KPN, and Pfizer NL.

Financial Implementation Consultant (part-time), *Cevinio* 2021 – 2024

- Led a student team automating invoice recognition and accounting with templates and machine learning; analysed client data and delivered presentations and training to multinational clients.

Statistics Teacher, *AthenaStudies* 2021 – 2023

- Led classes in elementary and intermediate statistical theory, with applications in R, at the Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam and Erasmus University, earning evaluations above 9/10 across 25+ courses.

Mandarin Language Study 2019 – 2025

- Studied Mandarin at Shenzhen University, the Chinese University of Hong Kong, Beijing Language and Culture University and LSE, developing proficiency in reading, writing and speaking (HSK1–HSK4).

Varsity Rower, *Skadi Rotterdam* 2019 – 2022

- Trained 8+ times a week in the heavyweight crew and competed in national Dutch student rowing events.

Grants, Awards and Training

– Participated in the Tools for Macroeconomists Summer School 2026
– Invited speaker (with Prof. Wouter den Haan), Erasmus University Trust Fund delegation to LSE 2026
– Full MSc scholarship funding: *Studiefonds Robert van der Rest*, *Fundatie van de Vrijvrouwe van Renswoude te 's-Gravenhage*, *Hendrik Muller's Vaderlandsch Fonds*, *Bekker-la Bastide-Fonds*. 2025
– Distinction, MSc Econometrics and Mathematical Economics, LSE 2025
– Honours, Double BSc in Econometrics & Economics, Erasmus University Rotterdam 2024
– Thesis ranked top five in cohort, Erasmus University Rotterdam 2024

Miscellaneous

Languages: Dutch (native), Spanish (native), English (fluent), French (B2), Mandarin (B2)
Nationalities: Dutch – Colombian – Canadian
Test scores: GRE Quantitative 170/170, Verbal 160/170

Research Contributions

Papers contributed to as a research assistant.

Bahaj, Saleem, and Ricardo Reis (2026a). The Anatomy of a Peg: Lessons from China's Parallel Currencies. *Journal of Political Economy*, forthcoming.

Bahaj, Saleem, and Ricardo Reis (2026b). The Fiscal Implications of Parallel Currencies. *Journal of Macroeconomics*, forthcoming.

Reis, Ricardo (2026a). Inflation after the Iran War. BIS Working Paper No. 1384.

Reis, Ricardo (2026b). Financial Repression in the XXIst Century. *IMF Economic Review*, forthcoming.

Guerreiro, Joao, Jonathon Hazell, Diego R. Känzig, and Ed Manuel (2026). The Macroeconomic Effect of Stimulus Checks: Evidence from Postwar Veterans' Payments. Working paper.

Catherine Chen, Chen Gao, Jonathon Hazell, Lihua Lei, and Chen Lian (2026). Forecasting Inflation with Microdata: An Adaptive Machine Learning Approach. Working paper.